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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **JPMorgan Chase** offered \$1 million to settle sexual assault and harassment claims brought by a former investment banker weeks before he filed a lawsuit filled with lurid allegations that have captivated Wall Street. **A1**
- ◆ **The AI trade again** boosted major U.S. stock indexes, with the S&P 500 rising 1.5% to a record and the Nasdaq and Dow gaining 2% and 1.2%, respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **Recent labor-related** reports suggest that the U.S. job market is reviving after a sluggish stretch for employment for most of the past year. **A3**
- ◆ **Eurozone wage growth** is set to slow this year, despite the rise in energy prices that has accompanied the conflict in the Middle East. **A6**
- ◆ **In a letter accompanying** Disney's quarterly results the company's new chief executive laid out a vision for its future, one that uses technology to reach consumers and increase profit. **B1**
- ◆ **Novo Nordisk** lifted its full-year guidance after the Wegovy maker reported increasing demand for its new weight-loss pill. **B1**
- ◆ **Samsung's market** capitalization surpassed \$1 trillion as its stock continued to benefit from the artificial-intelligence boom. **B1**
- ◆ **CVS beat Wall Street's** earnings expectations and upgraded its full-year projections, adding to a string of stronger results from health insurers. **B3**
- ◆ **Uber reported** higher revenue and gross bookings for the first quarter, as trip volumes and the number of its active users continued to grow. **B4**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Iran and the U.S.** are working with mediators to hammer out a 14-point memorandum of understanding that would establish a framework for a monthlong period of talks to end the war. **A1**
- ◆ **The U.S. and China** are weighing official talks on artificial intelligence as the countries' competition for preeminence in the technology threatens to become the arms race of the digital era. **A9**
- ◆ **The FBI searched** the office of a Virginia state lawmaker who was instrumental in the Democrats' recent push to redraw congressional maps. **A3**
- ◆ **A federal judge unsealed** a purported suicide note from Jeffrey Epstein, who died in August 2019 in jail after he was charged with sex trafficking conspiracy. **A4**
- ◆ **Commerce Secretary** Howard Lutnick told a congressional panel he was surprised when he received an invitation to visit Epstein's private island in 2012. **A4**
- ◆ **A trial began** for a man accused of establishing a clandestine police station affiliated with China's government that operated in Manhattan's Chinatown. **A3**
- ◆ **Commuters who drive** for 90 minutes or more each way to work are being hit hard by rising gasoline prices, with some skimping on other purchases to meet the cost. **A2**
- ◆ **A shipment of Ukrainian** cash and gold worth about \$82 million that Hungary seized was returned to Ukraine. **A7**
- ◆ **Died: Ted Turner**, 87, media giant who helped define the cable-TV industry. **A1**

CONTENTS	Markets & Finance B9
Arts in Review..... A13	Opinion..... A15-17
Business & Finance B2-5	Personal Journal A11-12
Business News..... B3	Sports..... A14
Crossword..... A12	Technology..... B4
From Page One..... A10	U.S. News..... A2-4
Heard on Street..... B10	World News..... A6-79



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Patients Evacuated in Race to Trace Deadly Virus



AFP/GETTY IMAGES

OUTBREAK: Three people, including two with acute hantavirus symptoms, were moved Wednesday from the MV Hondius off Cape Verde. Swiss authorities were trying to trace the contacts of a man who became ill after leaving the cruise ship. **A6**

As War Drives Up Fuel Prices, Trump's Advisers Are Worried

Aides want an end to Iran conflict ahead of midterms; airline lobby sounds alarm

By BRIAN SCHWARTZ AND ALISON SIDER

Former New Hampshire Gov. Chris Sununu delivered a warning to Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent during a recent visit to Washington: Already-high airfares will surge if the

war in Iran doesn't end soon. Sununu, a Republican who represents some of the biggest carriers as president of the industry group Airlines for America, has for weeks sounded the alarm to Trump administration officials about the economic fallout from high jet-fuel prices. The war, Sununu has argued, must come to a close soon, or things will get worse. Administration officials have gotten the message. Privately, President Trump's

advisers are increasingly worried that Republicans will pay a political price for spiking fuel costs, according to people familiar with the matter. Many of those advisers are eager to end the war in hopes that prices will begin moderating before the midterm elections in November. The fallout from the U.S.-Israeli attack in late February has slowed traffic through the Strait of Hormuz, a vital shipping lane, triggering a sharp increase in oil, gasoline and

jet-fuel prices. That means consumers are grappling with high costs ahead of the summer travel season, as they consider vacation plans. Sixty-three percent of Americans said they put a great deal or a good amount of blame on Trump for the increase in gasoline prices, according to a new poll conducted by NPR, PBS and *Please turn to page A2*

◆ **Gasoline prices take toll on 'supercommuters'..... A2**

Iran, U.S. Working On Talks To End Fighting

Trump says Tehran agrees not to have nuclear weapon, but threatens new strike

Iran and the U.S. are working with mediators to hammer out a 14-point memorandum of understanding that would lay out a framework for a monthlong period of talks to end the war, people familiar with the matter said.

By Benoit Faucon, Summer Said and Alexander Ward

The discussion points would be the focus of talks that could resume as early as next week in Islamabad, they said. Iran has expressed openness to discussing its nuclear program, easing its earlier resistance, the people added. President Trump said on Wednesday that the U.S. has had "good talks" with Iranian negotiators and the country has agreed not to have a nuclear weapon. Iran claims its nuclear activities are for peaceful purposes. Details around the length of any suspension of Iran's uranium enrichment or the possible removal of enriched uranium from the country, along with Iran's assertion of a permanent role in overseeing the Strait of Hormuz, remain unresolved and are expected to *Please turn to page A10*

◆ **Heard on the Street: Will crisis cause recession?... B10**

Hardware City's Sad Tale of the Tape

Stanley Black & Decker abandons Connecticut city where it all began

By JOHN KEILMAN

NEW BRITAIN, Conn.—The city seal shows a bee-hive, seven bees and a Latin motto that translates to: "Industry fills the hive and enjoys the honey." The bees represent the companies that helped build New Britain into a robust manufacturing town, and the busiest of all was Stanley Black & Decker. Its factories once stretched for nearly a mile down Myrtle Street, pumping out millions of screwdrivers, drills and

other tools that, without exaggeration, helped build America over the past two centuries. All that is left is a tape-measure plant, but not for long. Production has ended, layoffs have begun and the factory will close for good on May 18, taking 300 jobs with it. The tape measures coming out of the plant were the best money could buy, say some trade workers, but their measurements were printed on only one side of *Please turn to page A10*

Bad Writing Is a Writers' Best Friend

People add typos, casual language to evade AI police

By TE-PING CHEN

As a professional writer, Sarah Suzuki Harvard says she isn't inclined toward overly exuberant prose. But these days, she finds herself going rogue. "I'll use aggressively casual language, like, 'hey yo, for real,' or drop a bunch of exclamation points," said Harvard, a 32-year-old copywriter in Brooklyn, regarding her posts and essays. "It feels so icky to do this, but it's what you have to do to sound human." Call it a reverse Turing Test. As AI-generated writing floods the internet, more people are trying to detect which creators *Please turn to page A12*

JPM Offered \$1 Million To Stave Off Sex Suit

By ALEXANDER SAEEDY

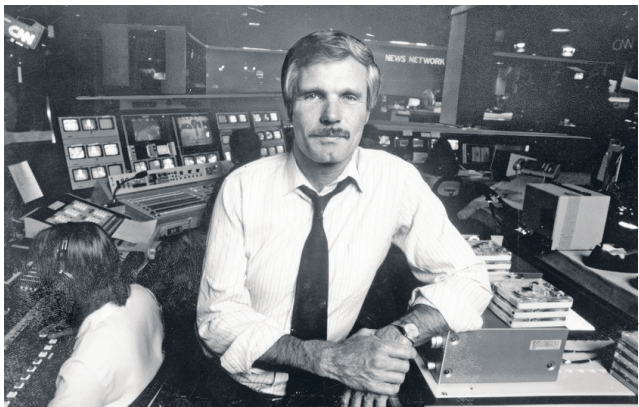
JPMorgan Chase offered \$1 million to settle sexual assault and harassment claims brought by a former investment banker weeks before he filed a lawsuit filled with lurid allegations that have captivated Wall Street, people familiar with the matter said. Chirayu Rana's lawsuit in New York state court, which was refiled on Monday after being taken down for a week, alleged that a female colleague sexually assaulted him and that co-workers inside the nation's biggest bank subjected him to racial discrimination. JPMorgan has said it conducted an internal investigation including multiple employees and doesn't believe there is merit to his claims. The lawyers for the female colleague, named in the lawsuit as Lorna Hajdini, have said they are entirely made up and that the two never had

any sexual relations. The allegations went viral after news reports of the suit's claims. AI-generated videos of Rana and the female banker proliferated on X and Instagram, bringing to life scenarios and dialogue from the lawsuit. The dispute over the validity of the claims and Rana's credibility only fueled public speculation over the past week, with podcasters like Joe Rogan and Megyn Kelly opining about what really happened. JPMorgan's offer to settle for \$1 million, equivalent to less than two years of his compensation at the bank, was aimed at avoiding all of that, but Rana rejected it and asked for more money, the people said. In a statement, a JPMorgan spokesman said, "We did try to reach an agreement to avoid the time and expense of litigation and to support an *Please turn to page A2*

Turner, Who Shaped Cable TV And Founded CNN, Dies at 87

By AMOL SHARMA AND ANNE STEELE

Ted Turner, the media titan who helped shape the modern cable-television industry, ushering in an era of 24-hour news with CNN while building other major networks that bear his name, died Wednesday at age 87, a spokesman said. Adventurous and impulsive, Turner made a mark in many walks of life. He was a sailor, a conservationist who was one of the largest U.S. landowners, and a philanthropist who helped set a model for generous giving by billionaires. He was best known for turning the billboard-advertising company he inherited from his father into Turner



NEWIMAGES/REUTERS

Ted Turner's CNN redefined how breaking news is covered.

Broadcasting System, an Atlanta-based TV and movie giant that he sold in 1995 to Time Warner. Turner joined the company and stayed with

it through its ill-fated January 2000 merger with America Online before leaving in 2003. As Turner battled rival me- *Please turn to page A4*

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